

THE ENTREPRENEUR'S GUIDE TO **FINDING THE PERFECT VIRTUAL ASSISTANT**

Including

- **GETTING STARTED
WORKSHEET**
- **WHERE TO LOOK**
- **COMMON MISTAKES**
- **INTERVIEW CHECKLIST**

You're a #BossLady.

You've poured every bit of yourself into your business. You're doing what you love and putting positive stuff out into the world. You're seeing real success, but are you enjoying it? Are you still spending hours fiddling with your website when you could be working on your next big idea? And are you wasting days messing around with social media with no real results when you could be focusing on big picture goals for the next year? Please don't tell me you're up late at night answering emails and trying to schedule meetings when you could be hanging out with your family or having a glass of wine with a girlfriend!

It's time for an upgrade. You need a virtual assistant. This guide will provide you with everything you need to find perfect fit for your awesome business.



ASK YOURSELF THESE QUESTIONS

WHAT WILL THIS ROLE LOOK LIKE? HOW MANY HOURS PER WEEK DO I REQUIRE SUPPORT? WHAT WILL THE V.A.'S MAIN FOCUS BE (I.E. MARKETING, CUSTOMER SERVICE)

WHAT PROGRAMS DO I USE THAT MY V.A. SHOULD KNOW HOW TO USE?

WHAT WILL MY V.A.'S MAIN DUTIES BE?

3 TOP QUALITIES I'M LOOKING FOR

WHAT IS MY BUDGET?

1

2

3

HOW DO I SEE THIS ROLE EVOLVING AS MY BUSINESS GROWS?

WHERE TO LOOK

FREELANCING SITES LIKE UPWORK.COM AND FREELANCER.COM

There is a huge pool of talent on these websites, but you might find yourself overwhelmed by the amount of responses you receive.

Some questions to ask yourself as you look at bids from freelancers: Have they filled out their entire profile? Do they provide examples of their work? Did they answer every question I asked in the job description? Did they send me a personalized response or a generic one? Do they have reviews from former clients?

SOCIAL MEDIA

Experienced virtual assistants often move away from the popular freelancing websites and begin marketing themselves on social media, especially on Instagram and LinkedIn. Use the hashtags #VA and #virtual assistant to find some candidates that you feel are a good fit for your business.

One plus about looking on social media is that you'll really get a taste of their marketing skills and personality. If you don't like the way their marketing themselves, chances are you won't like working with them.

ASK OTHERS IN YOUR INDUSTRY

If you have a network of friends who are also running online businesses, chances are they have an awesome V.A. they can refer you to. They might even know someone that is an expert in your particular niche. Try asking around!

USE A RECRUITER LIKE VIRTUALSTAFFFINDER.COM

They'll help you get the job description down and the right person for the job, but chances are, they'll probably find them on Upwork or Freelancer. Ask yourself if the money spent on a recruiter is worth the time you'd spend looking on freelancing sites.

COMMON MISTAKES AND HOW TO AVOID THEM

1

GOING WITH THE LOWEST BIDDER

As the saying goes: "You get what you pay for." I've seen V.A.s charging as little as \$4/hour. There is no way someone can run a sustainable business that way. You will put time and money into training someone, only to have them flake out or move on to a higher paying job. Investing in the right person will save you money in the long run.

2

NOT SPENDING ENOUGH TIME ON YOUR SEARCH

During your search., you'll probably come across of lot of people that LOOK great. But are they the right fit for YOUR business? Try having them complete some test tasks or doing a trial week before giving them the keys to the kingdom.

3

NOT THINKING AHEAD

It's important to consider what your needs will look like as your business grows. Sure, right now you just need a little help with social media, but you might need more project management and content creation in the future. Make sure your V.A. is someone who can grow with your business.

4

OVERLOOKING V.A.S THAT LACK SKILLS IN A SPECIFIC PROGRAM

Maybe you use MailChimp, but they only have experience in ConvertKit. This should not be a dealbreaker. A good V.A. should be able to learn new programs. Choose flexibility and ability to adapt over specific experience.

5

NOT BEING READY FOR A V.A.

Make sure to have a process in place for onboarding your new V.A. Keep deadlines clear and plan in advance as much as possible. Having unrealistic deadlines and not providing your V.A. with what they need to complete their tasks, could result in them moving on to a new client.

Interview Questions

Name _____

Date _____

- ☐ What is your availability? (How many hours per week? What times of day?)
- ☐ How many clients do you currently have?
- ☐ Do you have experience with these programs? (Use p.2 worksheet)
- ☐ Tell me about a time when you were asked to do something that you didn't know how to do.
- ☐ Tell me about a time when you made a mistake. How did you fix it? How did you communicate about it?
- ☐ What is your least favorite thing you've been asked to do by a client?
- ☐ Have you ever worked for a client in my specific industry?
- ☐ Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- ☐ Is there anything in the job description that you haven't had experience with?
- ☐ What is the last book you read?
- ☐ Do you have any hidden skills that would be helpful to my business?
- ☐ What about the job description inspired you?

Notes

